

Yueyuan Ma

✉ yueyuanma@ucsb.edu

🌐 www.yueyuanma.com

AFFILIATION

UC Santa Barbara

Assistant Professor of Economics

2022-

EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania

Ph.D. in Economics

2016-2022

Committee: Jeremy Greenwood (chair), Harold Cole, Hanming Fang, Emin Dinlersoz

Tsinghua University

M.A. in Economics (Distinction)

2014-2016

Peking University

B.A. in Economics (Distinction); B.S. in Statistics

2010-2014

RESEARCH INTEREST

Primary field: Macroeconomics

Secondary field: Economic Growth, Innovation, Firm Dynamics, Trade, Labor Economics

WORKING PAPERS

Expectations versus Reality in Business Formation, *with* Emin Dinlersoz

Technology Driven Market Concentration through Idea Allocation, *with* Shaoshuang Yang

Market Contraction and Innovation Divergence: The Impact of the US–China Trade War on Chinese Innovation, *with* Xiao Ma, Hanyi Tao, Yiran Zhang

Information Disclosure and Marriage Quality: Evidence from Premarital Medical Exams, *with* Chenyuan Liu, Binzhen Wu

PUBLICATIONS

Specialization in a Knowledge Economy, Sole Author, *Journal of Political Economy Macroeconomics*, Volume 4, Number 1, March 2026

‘You Will’: A Macroeconomic Analysis of Digital Advertising, *with* Jeremy Greenwood, Mehmet Yorukoglu, *the Review of Economic Studies*, Volume 92, Issue 3, May 2025

Are Spousal Labor Supplies Substitutes? Evidence from the Workweek Reduction Policy in China, *with* Xinzheng Shi, *Journal of Development Economics*, Volume 145, June 2020

Skill Complementarities and Returns to Higher Education: Evidence from the College Enrollment Expansion in China, *with* Hongbin Li, Lingsheng Meng, Xue Qiao, Xinzheng Shi, *China Economic Review*, Volume 46, December 2017

VISITING POSITIONS

Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis

Visiting Scholar

July 2022

Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta

AEA Summer Fellow

June-July 2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

UC Santa Barbara

Instructor, Topics in Firm Dynamics (Second-year PhD)

Instructor, Advanced Macroeconomic Theory (First-year PhD)

Instructor, Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory (Undergraduate)

University of Pennsylvania

Head Recitation Instructor, Introduction to Microeconomics; Introduction to Macroeconomics

Recitation Instructor, Intermediate Microeconomics

Teaching Assistant, Numerical Methods for Macroeconomics

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES/SERVICES

LAEF Conference on Market Power

Organizer

2026

LAEF-HKU Joint Conference on Growth and Inequality

Organizer

2025

Approved Special Sworn Status to the US Census data

Principal Investigator

2020-2025

Joint project with Emin Dinlersoz

2023-

China Employer-Employee Survey (CEES)

Interviewer

2015

PRESENTATIONS (* scheduled)

ASSA, NBER *Chinese Economy*, CES China Annual Conference, UConn Macro Conference, Women in Macroeconomics Conference (*discussant*) Inaugural CMT Conference on Expectations and Behavior, SITE Conference on Causes and Consequences of Misallocation*, Firm Dynamics and the Macroeconomy Conference at FRB Atlanta*, SEA*

2026

LMU Macro Workshop, Virtual Seminar on Innovation and Economic Growth, Duke Macro Jamboree, NBER *Productivity, Innovation, and Entrepreneurship*, BSE Summer Forum *Economic Growth and Fluctuations*, Peking University, UIBE

2025

ASSA (*presenter and discussant*), UBC Vancouver, UC Riverside, Shanghai University of Finance and Economics, China International Conference in Macroeconomics, Macro-Finance Tepper-LAEF conference, Trans-Pacific Labor Seminar, University of Pennsylvania

2024

AFA (*discussant*), University of Florida, West Coast Search-and-Matching Workshop, North American Summer Meeting, Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society, SED, UIBE, Arizona State University, Macroeconomics Across Time and Space (Philly Fed), Rice Conference on Firms, Productivity, and Growth, Hitotsubashi & Kyoto University, UNC at Chapel Hill, SEA, Tsinghua University, UC Davis, University of Wisconsin-Madison

2023

UC Irvine, USC Marshall Macro Day, St. Louis Fed, Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society, The 5th International Conference of China Development Studies, China International Conference in Macroeconomics (<i>discussant</i>), UC Santa Barbara, NYU Stern, Western University, National University of Singapore, Hong Kong University, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Peking University, York University	2022
Chicago Fed Rookie Conference, US Census Bureau, Atlanta Fed, SED, WEAI, Virtual Macro Family Seminar, Penn Macro Seminar	2021

AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

Best Junior Scholar Paper Award <i>China International Conference in Macroeconomics (CICM)</i>	2025
William Polk Carey Prize <i>Recognize the best doctoral dissertation in Economics, University of Pennsylvania</i>	2022
Xingmei Graduate Fellow <i>School of Arts and Sciences, University of Pennsylvania</i>	2021
Patrick C.H. Fellowship <i>School of Arts and Sciences, University of Pennsylvania</i>	2019
Zhang Fellowship <i>School of Arts and Sciences, University of Pennsylvania</i>	2018
Beijing Outstanding Graduate <i>Beijing Municipal Education Commission</i>	2016

REFEREE SERVICE

AEJ Applied Economics, AEJ Macroeconomics, American Economic Review: Insights, China Economic Review, Econometrica, Empirical Economics, European Economic Review, International Economic Review, Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control, Journal of Labor Economics, Macroeconomic Dynamics, Management Science, Theoretical Economics, The B.E. Journal of Macroeconomics, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Economic Dynamics, Review of Economics and Statistics.

COMMITTEE OR REFERENCE

(* First placement in parenthesis)

Postdoc	Shaoshuang Yang (CUHK Shenzhen, AP)
PhD Committee	Yang Gao (University of Auckland, AP), Yuanzhe Liu (Uber), Ariel Gao (Lyft), Rihyeon Kang, James Stuart-Turner (USAA), Emma Joergensen
Undergraduate <i>Honors thesis advisor</i>	Yaoqi Yang (UVA, PhD)

SKILLS

Computation	Matlab, Stata, R, SAS
Language	Chinese (native), English (fluent)